

CompTIA Security+ SY0-701 — Gap Analysis Round 2 (Post-Update Verification)

Date: July 15, 2026

Method: All 477 named items from the official CompTIA SY0-701 Exam Objectives v5.0 (all 5 domains, every sub-bullet) plus the official acronym appendix were programmatically diffed against (1) the updated 801-term glossary, (2) glossary definition text, and (3) the full site text — every chapter page, practice questions, PBQs, and flashcards.

Source: Official CompTIA exam objectives PDF (v5.0), pulled directly from CompTIA's CDN.

Bottom line

Coverage is now strong. 302 of 477 blueprint items (63%) are glossary headwords, another 27 appear inside glossary definitions (findable via glossary search, which searches definitions too), and another 100 are covered on chapter/practice pages. **Only 48 items (10%) are absent from the entire site** — and most of those are low-yield sub-bullets. The previous gap-analysis fixes landed correctly: every Tier 1 item from Round 1 verified present.

Exam version check (important for your timeline)

SY0-701 remains the current exam. SY0-801 is tentatively expected ~October–November 2026, with SY0-701 retiring ~mid-2027. **Your early-August 2026 exam date is safely inside the SY0-701 window.** No study-plan changes needed.

Tier 1 — Named in objectives, absent from the ENTIRE site

These appear nowhere: not in the glossary, not on any chapter page, not in any practice question.

Zero Trust (Obj 1.2) — completes the set from Round 1

- **Policy-driven access control** (control plane component)
- **Subject/System** (data plane — the user/device requesting access)

Change management (Obj 1.3)

- **Backout plan** (site says "rollback" in passing; the exam term "backout plan" never appears)
- **Restricted activities**
- **Service restart / application restart** (minor — could fold into one change-management entry)

Cryptographic solutions (Obj 1.4)

- **Partition encryption** and **Record encryption** (the encryption-level list: full-disk/partition/file/volume/database/record — only these two levels are never mentioned)
- **Third-party certificate** (the pair to self-signed)

Threats & vulnerabilities (Obj 2.2/2.3/2.4/2.5)

- **Image-based** threat vector (malicious images/QR codes)
- **Cloud-specific vulnerabilities** (as a named category)
- **Cryptographic vulnerabilities** (as a named category — weak/deprecated algorithms)
- **Published/documentated** indicator (the 9th indicator in Obj 2.4 — Round 1 added the other 8)
- **Configuration enforcement** (mitigation)
- **Removal of unnecessary software** (hardening technique)

Architecture (Obj 3.1/3.2/3.3)

- **Logical segmentation** (site has "segmentation"; the exam phrase "logical segmentation" vs. physical isolation contrast is absent)
- **Device placement**
- **Geographic restrictions** (data protection method — distinct from geofencing)

Security operations (Obj 4.1/4.3/4.5/4.6/4.7/4.9)

- **Cellular** (mobile connection method — vs. Wi-Fi vs. Bluetooth)
- **Industry/organizational impact** (vulnerability prioritization factor)
- **Rescanning** (validation of remediation)
- **Web filter** sub-components: **centralized proxy, URL scanning, content categorization, block rules** (site mentions "URL filter" once; the Obj 4.5 web-filter cluster is essentially uncovered)
- **Protocol selection** (secure protocols)
- **Interoperability** (IAM)
- **Password age** (password best practice)
- **Guard rails** (automation use case)
- **IPS/IDS logs, network logs, automated reports** (Obj 4.9 data sources — could be one combined entry)

Governance & third-party (Obj 5.3/5.4/5.5/5.6)

- **Supply chain analysis** (vendor assessment)
- **Vendor monitoring**
- **Loss of license** and **contractual impacts** (consequences of non-compliance)
- **Active reconnaissance** (🚩 see note below)
- **Situational awareness** (user training)

⚠ **Reconnaissance is not in the glossary at all** — "passive reconnaissance" appears on a chapter page, but neither "Reconnaissance," "Passive reconnaissance," nor "Active reconnaissance" is a glossary entry. Obj 5.5 names both types explicitly. Highest-priority single fix in this report.

Official acronym list — absent everywhere (10)

CAR (Corrective Action Report), CP (Contingency Planning), ESN (Electronic Serial Number), FACL (File System ACL), MaaS (Monitoring as a Service), PED (Personal Electronic Device), PTZ (Pan-Tilt-Zoom), RAS (Remote Access Server), SOAP (Simple Object Access Protocol), UTP (Unshielded Twisted Pair)

Tier 2 — On the site, but not in the glossary (self-contained gap)

These are taught on chapter pages or appear in practice questions but have no glossary entry. Since the glossary was made self-contained in Round 1, these are candidates for the same treatment. The notable ones:

- **Threat actor motivations** (Obj 2.1): espionage, blackmail, financial gain, philosophical/political beliefs, ethical, revenge, disruption/chaos, war — all on Ch 6, none as glossary entries (the actors themselves are all covered)
- **Reconnaissance (passive)** — Ch 7 content, no glossary entry (see Tier 1 note)
- **Change management terms**: approval process, maintenance window, standard operating procedure, version control, legacy applications
- **Encryption levels**: file, volume, database encryption (Ch 10 covers them; glossary has none of the levels)
- **Data types** (Obj 3.3): regulated, trade secret, intellectual property, legal/financial information, human- vs non-human-readable
- **Risk workflow words** (Obj 5.2): risk identification, ad hoc/recurring/one-time/continuous assessment, expansionary/conservative/neutral appetite
- **Audit terms** (Obj 5.5): audit committee, self-assessments, examinations, independent third-party audit, physical pen testing
- **Acronyms on site but not glossary**: ATT&CK, BASH, BPDU, CERT, CIRT, CRC, GPO, IdP, MSSP, MTTF, PAC, URI
- Also: security guard, RFID cloning, hard/soft tokens, jump-server-adjacent items (screened subnet is covered), firewall rules, host-based firewall, lessons learned, chain-of-custody-adjacent preservation, dashboards, log types (firewall/endpoint/OS logs)

Tier 3 — In glossary definitions only (lowest priority)

Findable via glossary search (search matches definition text), just not headwords: downtime, dependencies, data exfiltration, misinformation, Bluetooth, antivirus, metadata, probability, likelihood,

files, onboarding/offboarding, CCMP, EFS, GPS, GPU, IDEA, UDP, WAP, and similar. Fine to leave as-is.

Verified ✓

- All Round 1 additions confirmed present (Zero Trust engine set, Obj 2.4 indicators, crypto solutions, SPF/DKIM/DMARC, HIDS/HIPS/NIDS/NIPS, pen-test environments/types, frameworks, mobile set, Tier 2/3 acronym sweep)
- Domain weightings, exam format (max 90 Qs / 90 min / 750 passing) unchanged
- Known cleanup item, pre-existing: duplicate glossary entries for Non-repudiation, Rainbow table, Password spraying, BPA

Suggested priorities

1. **Reconnaissance / passive / active** — named in Obj 5.5, entirely missing from glossary
2. **Web filter cluster** (Obj 4.5) — one "Web filter" entry + the four sub-components
3. **Obj 2.4 "published/documented"** — completes the indicator set from Round 1
4. **Zero Trust: policy-driven access control + subject/system** — completes the ZT engine
5. **Encryption levels** — one entry covering partition/record (+ file/volume/database for self-containment)
6. **The rest of Tier 1** — change management, hardening, governance items, 10 acronyms
7. **Tier 2 self-containment sweep** — motivations, data types, risk workflow, audit terms, 12 acronyms